

Some of them were looking for speakers for their HTPCs in their living rooms that were connected to LCD TVs. There was one who wanted speakers for music that they could use in their rooms. Some were still very keen on really powerful 5.1 set-ups for their gaming rigs.



So, with all our needs in mind, we went straight down to hardware haven – Lamington Road. It's possible to walk into any computer store there and ask for a particular model and you can get exactly what you need. A few shops favour certain brands though. We asked for a good 2.1 set of speakers first. We were shown some desktop Intex speakers – 2.0. We had to explain that we wanted something with a sub-woofer. Out came some iBall Tarang 2.1 speakers. These are 40-W speakers which look nice. The price was just around Rs. 1,600 – pretty affordable for anyone. I asked if I could see any Artis models, but the shopkeeper tried to show me 4.1 model of the same Tarang range of iBall speakers.

Artis for those who don't know, has a wide range of speakers of all sizes and types but they are priced well. The shop didn't have any Artis pieces with them, so we moved on to the next one a block away. This shop had some of the models – the S222 and the S111R (R denotes radio). It's a simple feature to have in a speaker set but very few models have that. One of my friends looking for the 5.1 speakers enquired if Artis sold any 5.1 speakers. They happen to, and they're called S-5555. The shopkeeper was willing to sell it for Rs. 3,400 or so. I suggested to my friend that we look around a little more before making the payment and leaving.

I knew that Logitech's Z-5500 was one of the most powerful 5.1 systems around. I asked to see if it was available any more and at what price. I got a quote for Rs. 20,000. The Audioengine A5 was unaffordable but I had a suggestion – the Audioengine A2. The 30W A2 is also very powerful even though it's a small set of speakers. The price of the A2 is almost half that of the A5.